

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10 5 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ J 6 2

♠ Q 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ J 6

♣ A K Q 10 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 6 3

♥ Q J 10 7

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 8 3

♠ J 8

♥ 9 6 2

♦ K Q 10 9 4

♣ 9 7 5

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

[showcards S:DJ W:D2 N:D4]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥Q, you played low and North won the ♥A.

North now plays the ♦J on which East plays the ♦2. What do you play now, and what is your plan.

Play the ♦3 and when North plays another ♦ win with your ♦A.

South hoped his ♦ suit would provide enough tricks to make the game. You can see that there is no entry to the South hand EXCEPT in ♦s, so you want to win your ♦A on the trick that North plays his last ♦. How can you tell which trick that is?

Only by watching what East plays. On the ♦J East played the ♦2, a low card signaling that he held an ODD number of ♦s. ODD must be either one or three so when he followed to the next ♦ you know he started with three. A little bit of counting tells you that North started with the doubleton Jack, so you want to win the second ♦ trick.

This defense holds North to one ♦ tricks, if you had let him win the second one he would have had 9 tricks.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 9 3
♥ 8 7
♦ Q 6 5
♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ 8 7 2

♥ J 9 5 2

♦ A 8 4 3

♣ 8 3



♠ J 10 4

♥ A K 3

♦ J 10 9

♣ A K Q J

♠ A 6 5

♥ Q 10 6 4

♦ K 7 2

♣ 10 5 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♣

Pass

3NT

2NT

Pass

All Pass

3NT by East

[showcards S:ST]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♥4, North plays the ♥J, won by East with ♥A.

East plays the ♠J, you follow with ♠5, dummy ♠3 and North plays the ♠2. East continues with the ♠10

Play the ♠6.

North's ♠2 tells you he had an ODD number of ♠s, obviously 3. Since East also must have 3, you must take your ♠A on the third round, depriving dummy of the extra ♠ trick.

East may now turn to the ♦ suit, but your side can win the first ♦ and drive out East's ♥K. You will win 2 ♥s, 2 ♦s and the ♠A, down 1